



Korean Soy Sauce Eggs (Mayak Gyeran)



Ingredients

- 6 large eggs
- Ice water (for ice bath)
- ½ cup (120ml) low-sodium soy sauce
- ½ cup (120ml) water
- 2 tbsp sugar (or honey)
- 1 tbsp toasted sesame oil
- 1 tbsp rice vinegar
- 3–4 garlic cloves, finely minced
- 2 green onions, thinly sliced
- 1–2 fresh red chilies, sliced (or ½ tsp gochugaru)
- 1 tsp toasted sesame seeds

Directions

1. **Boil the water:** Bring a pot of water to a rolling boil over high heat.
2. **Cook the eggs:** Gently lower eggs into the boiling water. Cook for exactly 6 minutes 30 seconds for jammy yolks (7 minutes for slightly firmer).
3. **Ice bath:** Immediately transfer eggs to a bowl of ice water. Let rest 5–8 minutes.
4. **Make the marinade:** Whisk together soy sauce, water, sugar, sesame oil, rice vinegar, garlic, green onions, chilies, and sesame seeds until sugar dissolves. Taste and adjust seasoning.
5. **Peel the eggs:** Gently peel the cooled eggs under lightly running water.
6. **Marinate:** Place peeled eggs in an airtight container or zip-lock bag. Pour marinade over, ensuring eggs are fully submerged. Refrigerate for a minimum of 4 hours, ideally overnight.
7. **Serve:** Slice in half, serve over rice, noodles, or enjoy on their own. Spoon extra marinade over as sauce. Garnish with additional sesame seeds and green onion.

Nutrition Information

Serving Size: 1 egg; Calories 78, Fat 5g, Carbohydrates 3g, Protein 6g

Notes

Secret #1: The Double Soak Method: After the first 4-hour marinade, briefly take the eggs out, shake the container, and rotate the eggs so the parts that were touching the bottom get direct marinade exposure. Return to the fridge for another 2–4 hours. The color and flavor depth is dramatically better.

Secret #2: Reuse Your Marinade (Wisely): The leftover marinade is liquid gold. Boil it for 2 minutes to eliminate bacteria, cool it down, and use it as a dipping sauce for rice, noodles, or tofu. Or marinate a second batch of eggs in it — the second batch is often even better because the marinade has matured.

Secret #3: Temperature of the Water Matters: Always start with *already boiling* water, never cold water. Starting in cold water and bringing to a boil makes it nearly impossible to time the jammy yolk correctly, because the egg heats unevenly. Boiling water = precise, consistent timing every single time.

🔥 **Extra Spicy Version:** Add 1–2 tablespoons of gochujang (Korean chili paste) to the marinade and double the fresh chilies. The heat develops beautifully over the marinating period.

🍯 **Honey Garlic Version:** Replace sugar with 3 tablespoons of honey and add an extra garlic clove. The honey creates an incredibly glossy coating and slightly caramelized exterior when the eggs are sliced.

🍷 **Miso-Soy Version:** Whisk 1 tablespoon of white miso paste into the marinade. It adds a fermented depth that tastes like it took days to develop. This is the grown-up, sophisticated version — dinner party worthy.